Rep. Tom Emmer on Saturday in America

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BRIAN:

Joining me now, Minnesota Republican Congressman and House Majority Whip Tom Emmer. Thank you so much for being here with us this morning, Congressman. So give me your pitch here. How are you seeing things on the ground 10 days before the midterms in Minnesota? And how are you seeing Michelle Tafoya's chances here? I mean, you saw the RCP polling averages. It is a tight race in a pretty deep blue state.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, it's just like the rest of the country. This is a, you know, our speaker goes around and he talks about how this is a contrast election, right? The contrast between common sense of Donald Trump and Republicans versus the crazy of these socialist, communist, Marxist, anarchists on the left. I also, though, talk about this is a turnout election, Brian. This is going to come down to a handful of votes across the country, for instance, for maintaining our majority in the House. You know, in 2018, the difference between Republicans losing 40 seats in the U.S. House of Representatives and staying in the majority was only about 120,000 cumulative votes across the country.

REP. TOM EMMER:

It was that close. Minnesota is reflective of this as well. The polling, as long as you're in the margin of error, Brian, you don't know if Tafoya is on top or if Flanagan is on top. Flanagan has no business being there in the first place. I mean, you said she's tied to Tim Walz. She was right in the middle of the fraud scandals. She was dancing around wearing a hijab with a person who's been stripped of her ability to bilk Medicaid, a friend of hers for 25 years. I look Peggy Flanagan does not deserve any promotion based on the fraud, the waste, the abuse of her government authority that she's a she's used over the last several years with with Governor Tim Walz, who's frankly the worst governor in the in the country. Michelle Tafoya is a breath of fresh air, Brian. Michelle Tafoya is talking about Minnesotans, putting them first. And this is all about restoring law and order in Minnesota, making sure that the real Minnesota is represented in the rest of the country. I think Michelle not only has a great opportunity, I think she can win this seat. And it's all based on if our people show up, she's going to do well.

BRIAN:

You know, Congressman Emmer, I want to talk to you about the House as well here. And look, I know what you're feeling about the polls, but Fox News power rankings forecast that the Democrats right now are going to take control of the House with 237 seats on a good night. And on a good night for Republicans, the Fox News power rankings say you guys will win 216. That's too short of the majority. So as the House majority whip, what does the Fox News power rankings have wrong here? And can you make the case as to why you think the Republicans will keep the majority in the House?

REP. TOM EMMER:

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Well, I'll tell you the first off, there's no question. It's a different type of environment out there than what we had in 2024. The problem I have is I won't tell you all the polls are fake because, look, the polling is what it is, and you need to watch trends. You can't have two polls on the same day, for instance, about three weeks ago in Iowa. One says Ashley Hinson's up by five points. One says she's down by seven. I go back to this because before I was the whip, I ran the National Republican Congressional Committee, which is the campaign arm for the House. We won seats in both of the 20 and 22 elections and actually restored the majority. The 2020 election is the best example. 2020, it was predicted, and I'm not going to throw Fox in this because I don't remember where Fox was. Cook was putting all of these races in toss-ups, which I think is kind of a chicken-hearted way to handle it. You should call the outcome. We were being told the week before the election in 2020, you're going to lose another 24 seats in the House. Brian, on election night in 2020, we beat 12 Democrats and we darn near flipped the House for the first time in a two-year presidential election for the first time in almost 50 years. So why am I bullish? I'm bullish because our people have the message. We don't carry a national message on the ground. The U.S. House of Representatives is 435 pieces of geography, Each piece of geography has its own demographics. For us, it's candidate, it's money, it's message. We got the money, we've got the better candidates, and the message, the message is all about what we've done. The border is sealed. You've got no taxes on tips, no taxes on overtime. You've reduced the taxes. You put more Social Security money in seniors' pockets, and the list goes on and on. That's what we're doing, and that's why I believe we're going to be successful. Is it going to be a runaway? No, this country is evenly divided, but we will hold the majority in 10 days.

BRIAN:

OK, and my last question for you, I want to I want to make sure I I get your thoughts on Congresswoman Ilhan Omar. We know that there are now the two investigations into her, one on the immigration track, the other when it comes to her financial disclosures. A new DOJ filing showing that her name is Ilhan Noor Saeed Elmi. She denies that that is her real name. So do you think the DOJ will will find fraud here? And what actions do you think the House could take against her as this moves forward?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, there's no question that Ms. Omar's days are numbered. They finally have caught up with her. I mean, I'm not going to be surprised if the answer to whether or not she lied about her age in order to be naturalized when her father was illegally naturalized. I'm not going to be surprised if that's true. I'm not going to be surprised when they prove that she's not using her birth name. She's using a different name so that she could commit immigration fraud and a whole list of other things, Brian. But we're not going to have to do anything, because as soon as the administrative process through the DOJ is done and they prove that she was illegally naturalized, she's no longer a citizen of the United States. And guess what? You got to be a citizen. At least we still have that to serve in the U.S. House of Representatives. So I don't know that we're going to have to do anything except maybe follow up on the on the oversight of the fraud that she's involved in up to her eyeballs.

BRIAN:

And last 10 seconds here. Are you comfortable with the DOJ investigating her just three weeks before an election like this? I know that the norms usually DOJ usually does not do that. Investigate candidates 60 days before.

REP. TOM EMMER:

And this is an investigation started by the Biden Department of Justice. And the warrant that was issued for the search on October 12th was issued by, I believe, a Democrat appointed judge that was under the Obama

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administration. And you know that the standard had to be extremely high when you had Ilhan Omar as the subject of the search. So I'm entirely comfortable with the fact that we've been talking about this for years, Brian. It's about time we get the truth.

BRIAN:

Majority Whip Tom Emmer, thank you so much for taking as much time as you have with us this morning.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you. Thank you, Brian.

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